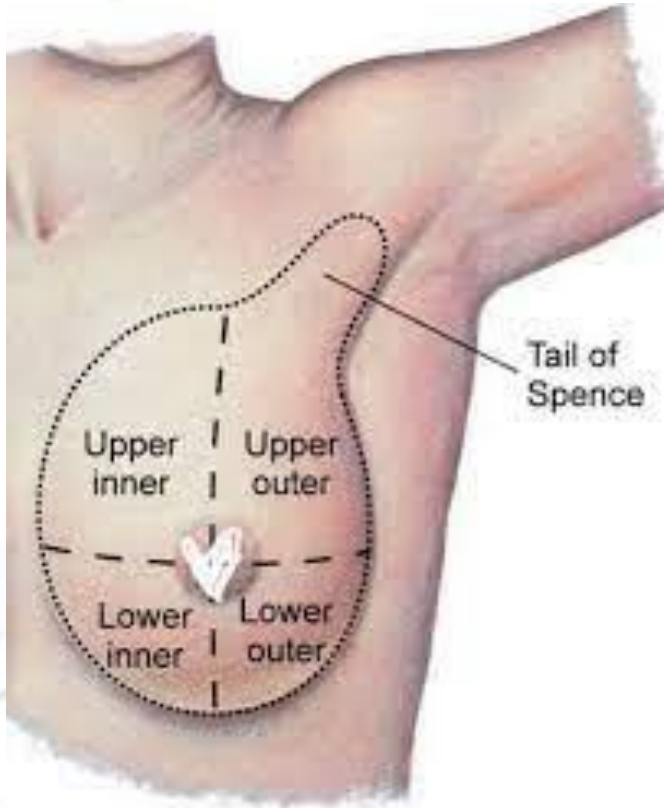
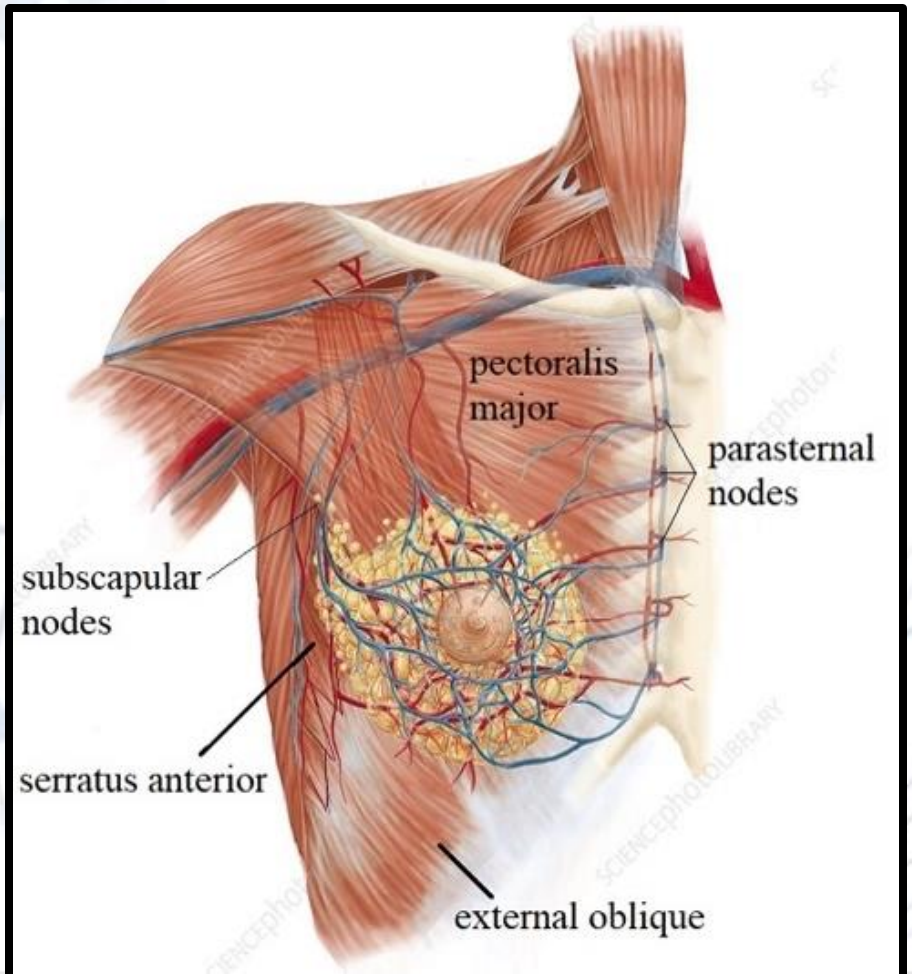
Shape

- Hemispherical and its upper lateral part has an extension into the axilla called axillary tail.
- The size, shape and contour are variable according to the age, body weight and lactating state.
- In males, the glandular tissue is rudimentary with scanty fat.



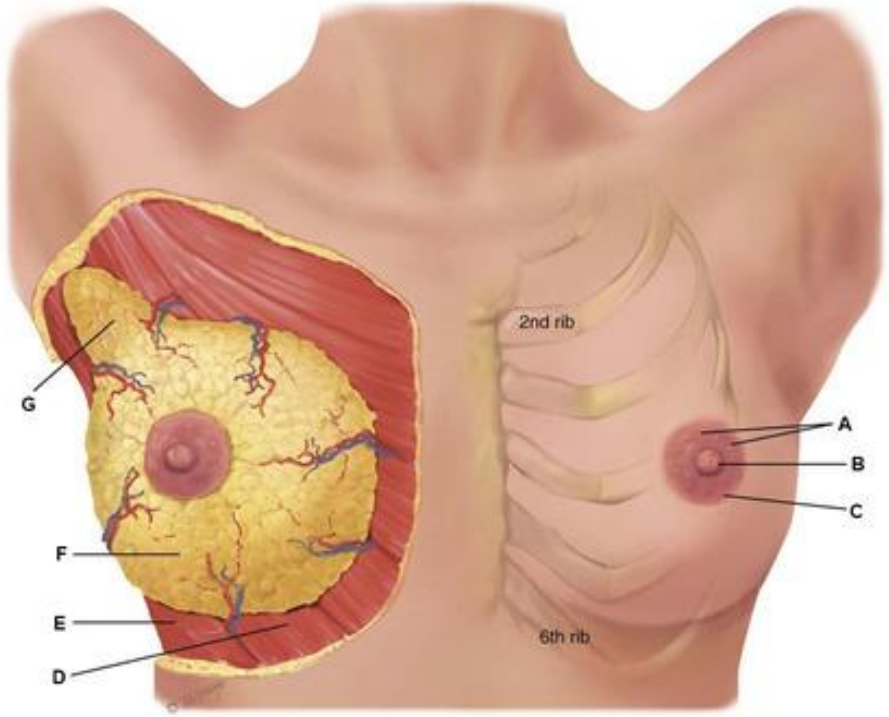
Base of the mammary gland

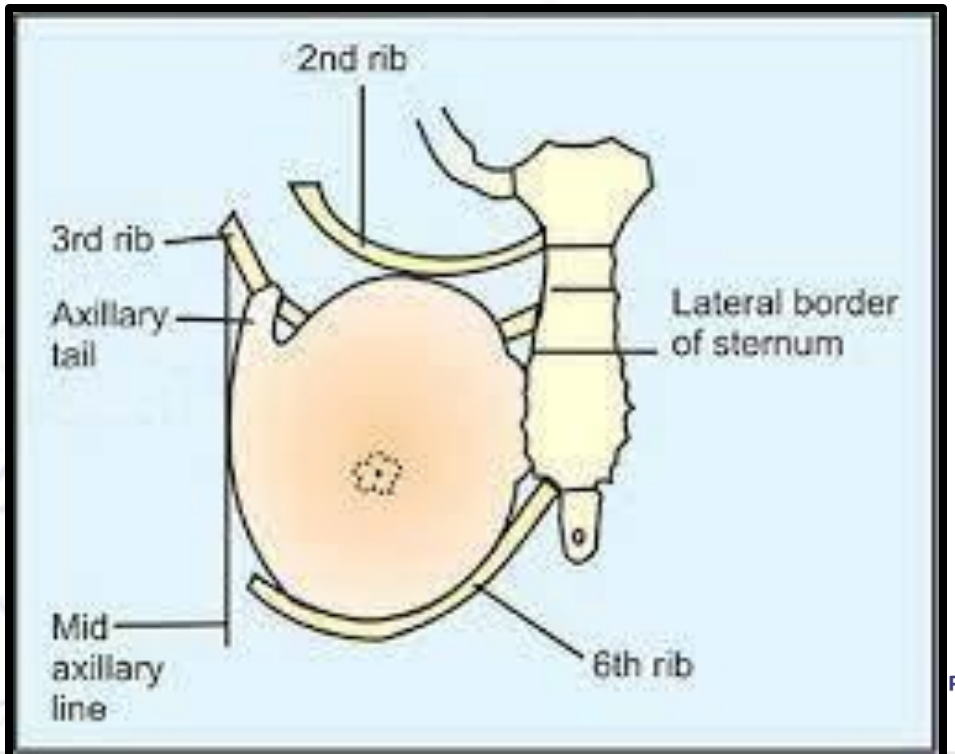
It rests on the **pectoralis major, serratus anterior and external oblique muscles.**



Base of the mammary gland

- It extends from the 2nd to the 6th ribs and from the sternal margin to the midaxillary line.
- The nipple lies opposite the 5th intercostal space in males and in females before puberty.

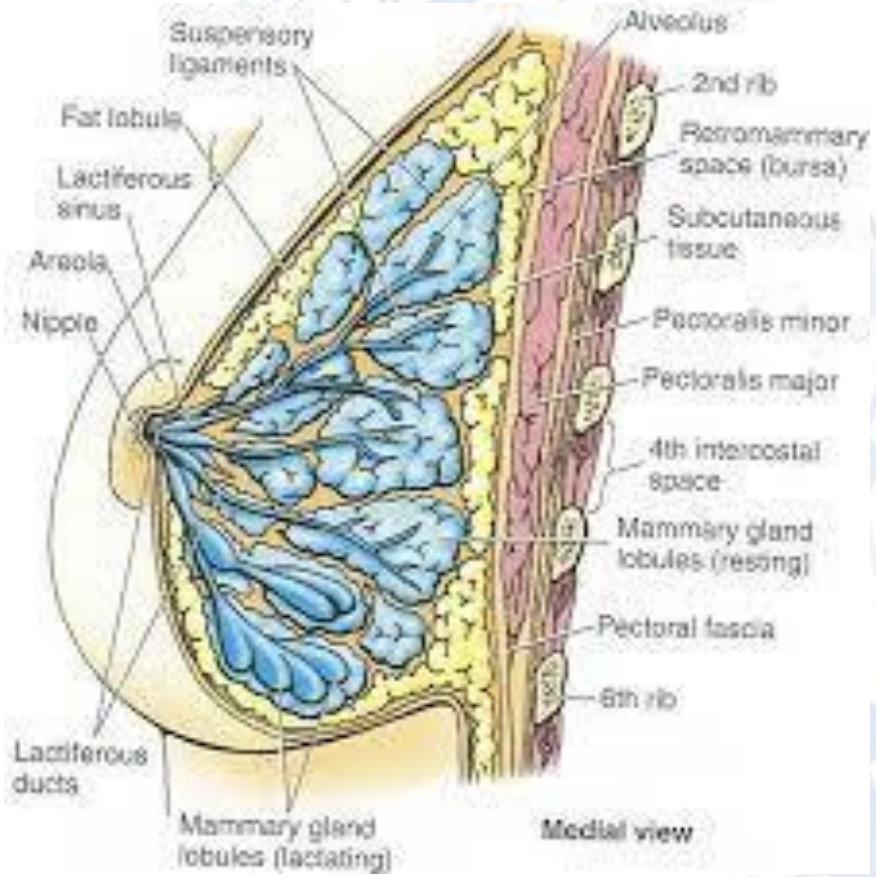




ANU MEDICAL SCHOOL PROGRAM

Base of the mammary gland

The breast is separated from the underlying muscles by a space called retro-mammary space containing loose areolar tissue that allows some degree of movements of the breast.



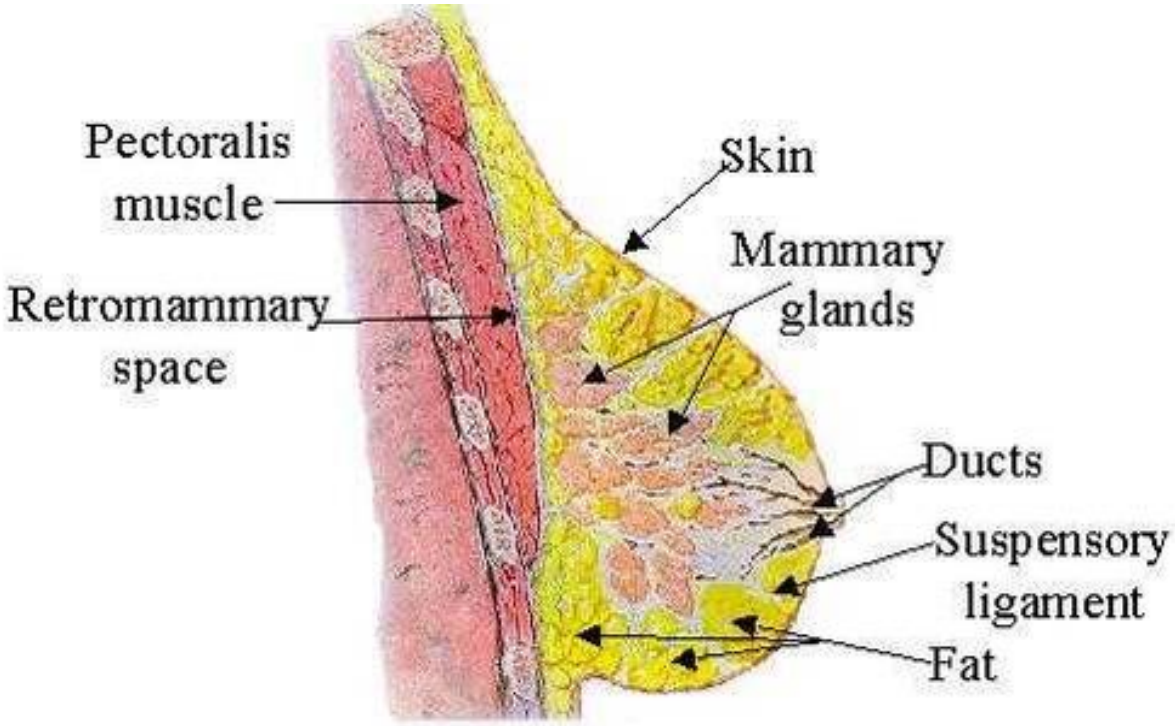


Figure 1. The female breast